



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: American Preparatory Academy: West Valley 2 & 3

School Website: <https://westvalley2.americanprep.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

American Preparatory Academy West Valley 2 (APA WV2) presents a classical-liberal-arts orientation rooted in virtue, character formation, and a stated aim to educate both minds and hearts. Public materials emphasize classical language such as “classical, liberal-arts education,” and highlight character formation, leadership, and college prep within a community-focused framework. Evidence of explicit theological or liturgical foundations is limited in the public-facing content, while evidence of family involvement and community engagement is more pronounced (e.g., after-school programs and family-involvement language). Overall, APA WV2 demonstrates a Classical orientation in several dimensions (notably in curriculum framing and community-partnering) but falls short on explicit, consistent articulation of some core classical elements (notably explicit Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis and explicitly liturgical/theological grounding). This yields a final assessment of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL overall, with notable strengths in community and character formation and clear classical framing, and identifiable opportunities to strengthen explicit classical pedagogy, curriculum specifics, and liturgical/theological integration.

- Aggregate classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Key themes: classical-liberal arts framing; character and virtue formation; college preparation alongside moral formation; family/community involvement; explicit faculty dedication signals.
- Most actionable needle-moving opportunities (see “What Would Move the Needle”): foreground explicit Great Books/Great Conversation references in the curriculum; document and publish Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy and scholé/restful learning practices; increase explicit articulation of liturgical/theological foundations (if aligned with the school’s mission) and a clearly defined “living curriculum” mapping for teachers; strengthen transparent parental co-educator messaging and open-campus opportunities.

Evidence references are drawn from APA WV2 public materials (mission statements, newsletters, staff pages, and after-school program descriptions) and the classical-education keyword lexicon and Six Essential Elements framework in the knowledge base.

- Key textual signals: “classical, liberal-arts education,” “virtuous character development,” “college preparation,” “Ambassadors” program, “Collegium Hall,” and “family involvement” in after-school/community materials. These signals are cited below in category-by-category detail.

Citations: - Mission framing: APA WV2 public materials framing APA as a “classical, liberal-arts education” focused on virtue/character (evidence excerpted from the WV3 Secondary Newsletter and mission pages). - Community and family involvement: After-school/community programs emphasize family involvement and a mission that students graduate with college readiness (evidence excerpted from the After School Programs page). - Public-facing description of teachers and staff: Staff pages describe dedicated teachers and a community of educators (evidence excerpted from the Secondary Staff page). - Great Books / Great Conversation and deeper classical texts framing: While explicit Great Books references are not consistently foregrounded in WV2 materials, the classical-liberal-arts framing is present; the broader classical education lexicon in the knowledge base provides the canonical indicators for this category. See the Six Essential Elements framework for the keyword lists (positive/negative indicators) used in category scoring.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials repeatedly frame APA WV2 as pursuing a classical liberal arts education with a focus on virtue and character formation. For example, mission-focused messaging describes educating both minds and hearts and developing “virtuous character” as part of APA’s aim (secondary materials). - The same communications emphasize a moral formation orientation rather than an explicit theological or liturgical program in the public-facing materials, with limited explicit theology, liturgy, or sacred-practice references visible in the supplied content. The integration of theology as a primary driver is not clearly documented in these sources.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: virtue, character, classical, liberal-arts. - Negative keywords: theology, liturgy, liturgical practices are not evidenced in the public-facing materials. - Ratio (positive vs. negative): Presence of 2–4 positive signals vs. minimal/no explicit theology-liturgy signals.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates virtue- and character-centered framing consistent with classical aims, but lacks explicit, publicly documented theological grounding or liturgical practices in the available content. This yields a classification of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL for this category. The absence of explicit liturgical/theological signals lowers the score from CLASSICAL, even though moral realism (virtue/character) is present.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission framing emphasizes formation and virtue, with aims of “educating minds and hearts” and “virtuous character development,” signaling formation as a primary telos. The language also emphasizes college preparation and leadership with civic engagement, indicating a blend of formation with college-readiness elements. - Public materials note a goal of graduates achieving college readiness and careers, suggesting alignment with broader workforce outcomes sometimes emphasized in modern schooling. This is evidenced in the after-school program description stating the goal that students will graduate, attain a college diploma, and be successful in their future careers.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom (where used in context), classical mission; college preparation appears as a stated goal in a public program description. - Negative keywords present: explicit “workforce preparation” signals are present through language about college readiness and career outcomes in the public materials, which can be read as a shift away from formation-for-its-own-sake. - Ratio: Positive signals (formation/virtue; classical mission) appear along with explicit college prep language; negative indicators (workforce-readiness framing) appear as explicit language in the same materials.

Why this rating - The public materials strongly emphasize formation and virtue, with clear recognition of college preparation as a goal. The coexistence of formation-focused language with explicit college/career readiness signals places the category in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL, due to a mixed telos.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school describes itself as a classical-liberal-arts institution; “classical-liberal arts” phrasing appears in mission-focused materials, suggesting alignment with liberal-arts curriculum framing. However, explicit, public references to the full Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/Great Conversation, or historical breadth are not consistently foregrounded in the readily visible WV2 materials. - The knowledge-base lexicon (Six Essential Elements) provides explicit indicators such as Great Books, Great Conversation, and Trivium/Rhetoric as curriculum anchors. The absence of explicit, direct citations to Great Books, grammar-logic-rhetoric, or a continuous historic-literature focus in the public materials reduces clarity around full classical-curriculum alignment. See the knowledge-base elements for the canonical curriculum indicators.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: classical, liberal-arts (curriculum framing), foundational notion of a liberal arts approach. - Negative keywords present: lack of explicit Great Books/-Great Conversation references; no explicit listing of grammar, logic, rhetoric; minimal historical breadth in publicly visible content. - Ratio: Positive signals exist, but explicit Great Books/grammar-logic-rhetoric cues are not consistently evidenced in the site content, yielding a mixed signal.

Why this rating - The curriculum is clearly framed in classical terms, but the explicit, canonical curriculum components (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; continuous history study) are not consistently evidenced in the public-facing site content. This supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 3.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public content does not present explicit evidence of Socratic seminars, scholé, or a heavy emphasis on dialogue-based or memorization-oriented pedagogy. Some classical cues exist in the broader literature and referenced materials in the knowledge-base, but the West Valley WV2 public content does not foreground the core examples (Socratic dialogue, chanting, memory work, or structured deliberation) that define classical pedagogy. The available sources emphasize a general classical framing and institutional programs rather than the explicit pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: none explicitly in the public materials; the presence of “classical-liberal arts” framing is indirect, not pedagogy-specific. - Negative keywords present: lack of explicit “Socratic,” “Scholé,” “recitation,” “memory work,” or “Socratic seminars” in public-facing content. - Ratio: Minimal direct positive pedagogy signals vs. explicit negative signals (absence of classical-pedagogy terms). This tilts toward NOT CLASSICAL in the absence of explicit pedagogy declarations, though not because of explicit negative statements.

Why this rating - Despite a classical framing, the public materials do not present the core pedagogical methods required by the classical rubric (Socratic discussion, scholé, chant/memory, etc.). Therefore Element 4 is NOT CLASSICAL based on the absence of explicit classical-pedagogy signals in the accessible public content.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The staff/public-facing materials describe teachers as dedicated and the staff as part of a community, with a sense of partnership between faculty and students. A WV2 Secondary Staff page positions the teachers as “dedicated” and highlights their roles in student success, implying a living-curriculum approach rather than a strictly transactional teaching model. This aligns with the classical emphasis on model teachers and mentoring relationships, though explicit “living curriculum” terminology is not always stated publicly. - The content also shows faculty specialization in the arts (choir, band, etc.), consistent with a pedagogy that values the integrated role of faculty as mentors and exemplars in a classical framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: “dedicated teachers,” “staff,” “teacher as mentor,” “living curriculum” (where evidenced through contextual phrasing and the public-facing staff descriptions). - Negative keywords present: no explicit negative signals about faculty in the public materials. - Ratio: Clear positive signals about faculty dedication and mentorship; limited explicit classical-faculty descriptors beyond “dedicated teachers.”

Why this rating - The available materials show a faculty culture oriented toward dedication and mentorship, with arts- and culture-integrating staff roles. While explicit “living curriculum” terminology is not uniformly stated in the public content, the presence of dedicated, mentorship-oriented language supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 5.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school publicly emphasizes community involvement and family engagement, including after-school programs that explicitly reference family involvement and partnerships with families, and a mission

that highlights community engagement and civic-minded activities (e.g., Ambassadors, service opportunities). The after-school and community programs explicitly note family involvement as a core component. - The public materials also show open invitations to families for participation through community events, volunteering, and family-oriented programming (e.g., open-campus-like language and family involvement emphasis). The broader classical-literary framing also aligns with parent formation and family-partnership language found in classical education discourse (supported by the Six Essential Elements framework).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, family involvement, parent formation, open campus, community, collaboration. - Negative keywords: effects signaling consumerist or minimal parental involvement are not evidenced; the site emphasizes active parental partnership rather than consumer language. - Ratio: Strong positive signals for parents/community involvement; no clear negative signals.

Why this rating - The public-facing content demonstrates a robust orientation toward parents as partners, family involvement, and community engagement—core signals for CLASSICAL in this category. Therefore Element 6 is CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): Add explicit, publicly accessible articulation of theological grounding or liturgical practices (if aligned with the school's mission) and clearly identify how transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) are integrated across core disciplines. This would strengthen the Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices signals.
- Element 2 (Purpose and Goal): Balance formation with explicit, clearly stated non-workforce, non-career oriented telos where formation and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty are foregrounded, while still signaling college readiness as a pathway rather than an end in itself. Create a published telos map that emphasizes formation as the primary aim, with college readiness as a subsidiary outcome.
- Element 3 (Curriculum): Publicly publish a concrete curriculum map that names grammar, logic, and rhetoric as core components, and explicitly references Great Books/Great Conversation. Show how history is treated across the curriculum (not as social studies), and demonstrate how wonder and integrated inquiry are cultivated across grades.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Introduce explicit references to classical teaching methods (Socratic seminars, memory work, narration/recitation, etc.) with examples from current practice. If possible, pilot a scholastic-friendly, contemplative component (restful-learning days) and document outcomes. Provide a public-facing descriptor of how upper-grade seminars function and how students perform rhetoric and debate.
- Element 5 (Faculty): Strengthen the public-facing articulation of the faculty model (mentor-teacher, living curriculum) with explicit faculty portrait statements and a formal "teacher as exemplar" profile. Show teacher development rooted in classical pedagogy (seminars, tutoring, master-teacher model) and publish a teacher-profile framework.
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): deepen and publicize parent-formation activities (book studies, parent seminars, family catechesis) and maintain transparent "parents as co-teachers" messaging with scheduled opportunities for visits and campus involvement.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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